

PART 5: BUSINESS RECOMMENDATIONS

Sample Superstore - Actionable Strategy

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RECOMMENDATION #1: Investigate and Fix Furniture's Profit Gap

Action: Conduct a cost review of the Furniture category — specifically shipping costs, discount levels, and supplier pricing.

Why: Furniture generates strong sales but disproportionately low profit compared to Technology and Office Supplies (see Sum of Profit by Category chart).

Expected Impact: Even a small improvement in Furniture's margin could meaningfully lift the company's overall 8.11% profit margin, since Furniture is a high-volume category.

RECOMMENDATION #2: Expand Investment in Phones and Chairs

Action: Increase inventory, marketing spend, and supplier negotiation focus on Phones and Chairs — the two top-performing sub-categories.

Why: These sub-categories already outperform all others in sales (see Sum of Sales by Sub-Category chart), showing proven customer demand.

Expected Impact: Doubling down on already-successful product lines is lower-risk than trying to grow weaker categories, and can drive incremental revenue growth quickly.

RECOMMENDATION #3: Investigate the Post-2016 Sales Decline

Action: Pull more recent data (post-2017) and compare against 2016 performance to

determine if the decline is a temporary dip or an ongoing trend. Review any competitive, pricing, or operational changes made after 2016.

Why: The Sum of Sales by Year chart shows a clear decline after peaking in 2016 — this needs to be understood before it becomes a larger problem.

Expected Impact: Early detection of a declining trend allows management to course-correct before it significantly affects annual revenue.

RECOMMENDATION #4: Build Consumer Segment Loyalty Programs

Action: Design a loyalty or rewards program targeted specifically at the Consumer segment, which already drives ~46.8% of total sales.

Why: The Sum of Sales by Segment chart shows Consumer as the clear leader — strengthening retention here has the largest potential revenue impact of any segment-focused initiative.

Expected Impact: Increased repeat purchase rate and higher average order value from the company's most valuable customer segment.

RECOMMENDATION #5: Set Regional Performance Targets Using the Dashboard

Action: Use the Region slicer and "Sum of Sales by Region" chart to set individual performance targets for West, East, South, and Central regions, and review them monthly.

Why: The dashboard already shows relatively even sales distribution across regions — formalizing targets ensures no region is quietly underperforming without visibility.

Expected Impact: Improved accountability and faster identification of regional issues before they affect overall company performance.

RECOMMENDATION #6: Adopt the Dashboard as a Standing Management Tool

Action: Move this Power BI dashboard from a one-time report into a live, regularly updated

tool used in monthly leadership meetings.

Why: The insights above (Furniture’s profit gap, the 2016 sales peak, Consumer segment dominance) were only visible because the data was consolidated into one interactive view — this value only continues if the dashboard is kept current.

Expected Impact: Faster, more consistent data-driven decision-making across the organization going forward.

SUMMARY TABLE

#	Recommendation	Priority
1	Fix Furniture’s profit gap	HIGH
2	Expand Phones & Chairs investment	HIGH
3	Investigate post-2016 sales decline	HIGH
4	Build Consumer loyalty programs	MEDIUM
5	Set regional performance targets	MEDIUM
6	Adopt dashboard as standing tool	MEDIUM

CONCLUSION

These six recommendations directly address the risks and opportunities identified in Part 4. Prioritizing the Furniture profit review and the post-2016 sales investigation will have the most immediate impact on business health, while the remaining recommendations build longer-term resilience and growth.